

September 23, 2026

Scientific Reports

Dear Dr. Yang,

V4 AUTHOR-REVIEW CANDIDATE

This revision prepared for author review concerns *RankCloak Conceals the Surface Form of Synthetic Cryptographic Artifacts in Language Model Generated Text* (submission 0170c7b2-1065-4344-a5d5-b839b51ac22c).

The V4 revision addresses the editor's technical assessment and Reviewer 1's ten points while retaining Reviewer 2's acknowledgment and all original review wording. It adds complete token-filter documentation, six strict-gate failure analyses with exact text windows and matched comparators, bounded transport decomposition, a configuration compatibility check, source-based complexity analysis and a directional fixed-message quantization endpoint. The conceptual block, integrity, ECC and retransmission fallback is explicitly unimplemented.

The adverse findings remain central. All 960 fixed Q4 messages fail exact recovery when decoded from saved Q8 ranks. The transport decompositions do not establish general robustness. Neither of two control-only pilots meets the prospective semantic control-separation requirement. Context gain passes its specified control check. The subsequent frozen likelihood study supports limited local compatibility. Ordinary controls are sampled and RankCloak continuations are greedy, so the contrast does not isolate a causal boundary effect. Semantic coherence and reader-perceived naturalness remain unestablished. The response to Reviewer 1 comment 4 is complete as a scientific explanation, with partial empirical coverage for the editor to assess. RankCloak concerns surface-form concealment under a shared configuration and does not establish confidentiality or indistinguishability against the evaluated trace-informed attacker.

The work is appropriate for Scientific Reports as a reproducible computational study of artifact representation, configured inversion and measurable failure boundaries. The revision retains adverse and null results and makes no claim of a robust or confidential communication channel.

Published version 2.0.0, DOI <https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.22555497>, covers V3 but not V4. The local V4 archive candidate is tied to a named source snapshot and accompanied by a verification receipt. Its public deposit and the corresponding DOI update remain required before resubmission. This letter is prepared for author review and records no new deposit, resubmission or acceptance.

Sincerely,

Alexander V. Mantzaris
School of Data, Mathematical, and Statistical Sciences
University of Central Florida
alexander.mantzaris@ucf.edu